OTT

A PLUM PART

Tahir Raj Bhasin loved getting under the skin of Vikrant, the character he plays in Netflix's *Yeh Kaali Kaali Ankhein*, whose second season is out now



To watch Tahir Raj Bhasin in Netflix's popular series *Yeh Kaali Kaali Ankhein* is to derive vicarious pleasure from the sheer misfortune that befalls his character Vikrant. If season one was all about feeling sorry for Vikrant as he dealt with an obsessive lover, in the recently released season, two shades of grey emerge as he loses sight of his moral compass in his desperate quest to get out of the compounding mess. Key to the show's clever subversion of Hindi cinema's tropes of crazy love and the love triangle is Bhasin's portrayal which highlights how troubling, tense and even darkly funny it is to be on the receiving end of unwanted passion. Writers Sidharth Sengupta and Varun Badola make Vikrant the show's narrator, giving audiences a peek into his inner psyche through sardonic soliloquies.

Bhasin knows it's the part of a lifetime, one that allows him to unleash his arsenal of thespian skills. "I have to very consciously put my blinkers on and be dead



ON POINT Filmmaker Onir; (bottom, right) a still from *We Are Faheem & Karun*

CINEMA

Queer Quartet

*National Award-winning filmmaker **Onir** has taken several creative leaps with his queer romance,* We Are Faheem & Karun



For Onir, the starting point for *We Are Faheem & Karun*, his latest Kashmir-set queer romance, began in 2018 when the Supreme Court struck down Section 377 of the Indian Penal Code, a draconian law that criminalised homosexuality. "At that point, I felt a deep calling as a storyteller to make a film that paid tribute to queer Indians," the National Award-winning filmmaker tells INDIA TODAY. "Until then, all my films that dealt with queer stories had been dark. Of course, I don't think the struggle is over for us. But I wanted to make something lighter."

To help his vision come to life, Onir brought Fawzia